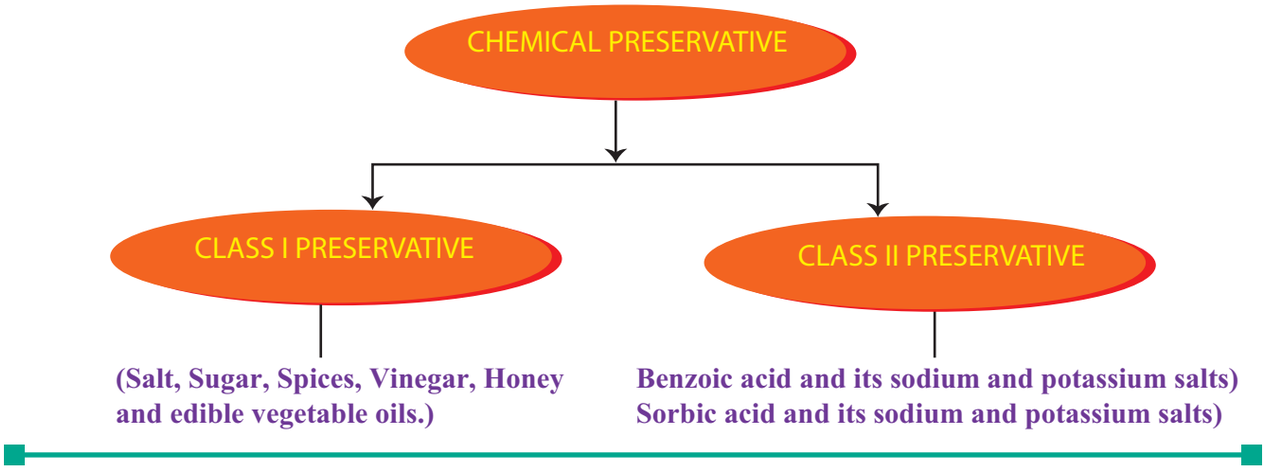


- Sorbic acid and its salts are effective against yeasts and moulds but less effective against bacteria. They are good preservatives for foods with high fat content e.g., low fat spreads and processed cheese.

Sulphite Fact

It is an effective and economical additive. Sulphites decolourise the anthocyanin pigment present in food; hence it is not used in grape crush and squashes. Instead sodium benzoate is used which retains the colour.

Household preservatives – vinegar (acetic acid) and ascorbic acid (in lemon) are used for preservation.

4.2.6 Preservation by High Osmotic Pressure

The principle of osmosis is used to preserve jams, jellies and pickles. In this process, water tends to draw out from microbes (*plasmolysis)* and makes it dehydrated, thus killing them. But yeasts and moulds are relatively resistant to high osmotic pressure. Hence, preserved foods like pickles tend to spoil if not stored properly.



Mango jam

4.2.6.1 High Concentration of Sugar

Sugar is used to preserve fruits. Preserving fruits in honey to avoid spoilage is a well known practice. Nowadays jams and jellies prepared from fruits have a high concentration of sugar and it acts as a preservative. Pectin, acid and sugar are essential to prepare jam. Jam or jelly are prepared by adding commercially prepared pectin and

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